

"The Bihar Museum Biennale is a pioneering effort, it is the world's first Museum Biennale. This year's third edition explores the theme 'Global South: Sharing Histories' which focuses on the shared experiences of economic and cultural subjugation across three continents; Latin America, Africa and Asia.

This curatorial choice celebrates the natural connections between these regions that share common cultural foundations. We're bringing stories that break free from the Global North's gaze. We gave the countries the freedom to interpret the theme and share their narratives in their own way.

The biennale was inaugurated on the 7th of August 2025 and will go on till 31st December 2025. You are welcome to come and take part in these stories of the Global South."

Anjani Kumar Singh
Director General, Bihar Museum

language and of course, the continuing legacies of the Ramayana and Mahabharata. India is a direct maritime neighbour with Indonesia, with the Andaman and Nicobar Islands lying just 160 kilometres from Indonesia's Sabang Island in Aceh Province. History here is measured not in centuries but in millennia of exchange, evolved from having been comrades in the struggle against colonialism, united in the pursuit of independence, to being partners shaping the post-colonial world order, and to becoming drivers of the Asian Century focused on the Indo-Pacific.

Ethiopia's presence is equally vivid, with works by Meron Hailu Abera, Hewan Mehra, Mihiretu Wassie, Surafel Amare Sisay, and Kirubel Melke, blending contemporary aesthetics with traditional forms, from collages made of buttons and leather scraps to textiles probing the tension between originality and adaptation in a globalised world. Together, these artists turn everyday experience and material into tactile, symbolic poetry. Their practices reach across geographies and traditions, resisting fragmentation and alienation to offer powerful, unified meditations on culture and belonging.

"Mexico: Living Echoes of an Ancestral Tradition" in Patna Museum Temporary Gallery brings together works by visual artist Eva Malhotra and the Embassy of Mexico in India. Eva's carved works, oil paintings, installations, performances, and photography draw inspiration from the Maya people, an Indigenous group with a millennia-old history primarily rooted in the Mesoamerican regions of Southern Mexico and Guatemala. Her works capture the mysticism and spirituality inherent in Mayan culture. From the Embassy of Mexico, one can experience the different cultures of Mexico through 12 pre-Hispanic artefacts and textiles and 13 photographs.

This exhibition offers a window into the soul of Mexico—its deep-rooted histories, vibrant cultures, and enduring creativity. Through archaeological treasures, folk traditions, contemporary textiles, and modern artworks, it traces the living legacy of Mesoamerican civilisations and foregrounds the vital role of women as keepers of knowledge, makers of form, and carriers of memory. Spanning over three millennia—from 1200 BCE to the present day—the works on display come from across Mexico and reflect a dynamic interplay of continuity and change. The exhibition becomes a bridge between India and Mexico—two sister cultures that have long turned to art as a means of remembrance, resistance, and renewal.

Sri Lanka's contribution brings together the distinct yet converging practices of artists Jagath Ravindra, Dr Shanaka Kulathunga, Pinki Kumari Tanuja Madawela, and Shehan Madawela, creating a dialogue between anatomy and abstraction, spirituality and materiality, each offering a unique meditation on form, memory, and emotion. Ravindra captures fleeting moments through shifting colour and scale, blending Impressionist transience with abstraction rooted in local sensibilities. Dr Shanaka Kulathunga, both doctor and artist, renders the human form with anatomical precision and quiet intensity, his figures often dissolving into nature, echoing the body's deep entanglement with its surroundings. Pinki Kumari draws from the cultural terrains of Bihar and Mysore, exploring materiality through texture, pigment, and found objects. Shehan Madawela, shaped by his education at Kala Bhavan, Shantiniketan and time in Bangalore and Mysore, engages with the spiritual, ecological, and multicultural through richly layered oil paintings, often enriched by the use of metallic leaf and acrylic. Together, their works form a resonant dialogue between the physical and the ephemeral, inviting viewers into layered worlds of body, space, and perception.